

LAB 5 • SERVICE ADMINISTRATION AND DISTRIBUTION

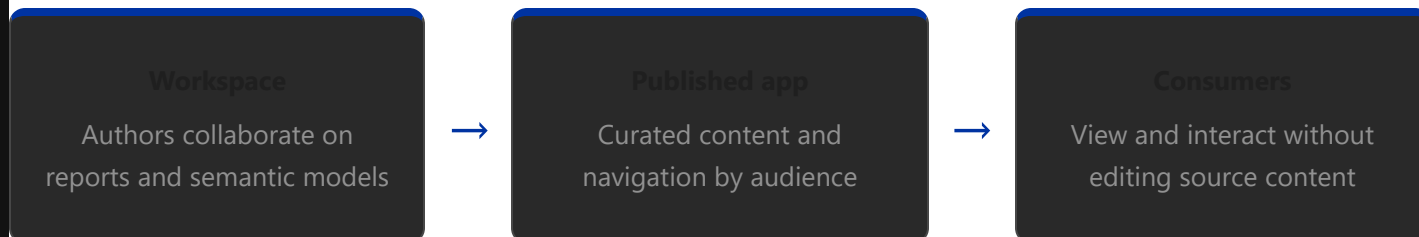
Manage workspaces, collaboration, apps, and refresh

Build a governed home for the report, assign least-privilege roles, publish a curated app for distinct audiences, and establish a refresh schedule that someone will actually monitor.

45–60 minutes Power BI Service Deliverable: governed workspace + published app

Understand the service lifecycle

A workspace is the team’s authoring and staging area. An app is the curated experience distributed to consumers. Scheduled refresh keeps the imported semantic model current after publication.



Key distinction: publishing or updating an app is a separate action from changing workspace content. The workspace acts as a staging area until an Admin or Member selects **Publish app** or **Update app**.

Create a governed workspace

Use the Power BI service in a browser. Power BI Desktop can publish to an existing workspace, but it cannot create one.

1. Sign in to the correct service endpoint for your tenant: GCC, GCC High, or DoD as identified in Lab 4.
2. Open **Workspaces**, then select **New workspace**. Depending on the current navigation, you might instead use **Create** → **Workspaces** or **+ New** → **Workspace**.
3. Name the workspace **Coding-Forge Supply Chain - Training**, or use the instructor-approved naming standard.
4. Add a useful description and contact list. Use a monitored group or at least two accountable owners rather than one person.
5. Confirm the assigned capacity and license model with the instructor. Do not change capacity settings without approval.
6. Select **Save**, then open **Workspace settings** and verify the name, contacts, and license information.

Missing New workspace? Your tenant administrator might restrict workspace creation, your license might not permit it, or you might be in Desktop instead of the browser service. Do not work around tenant restrictions; request an approved workspace.

Assign collaboration roles

Open the workspace and select **Manage access**. Prefer Microsoft Entra groups over individual assignments when your organization has approved groups for the team.

Admin
Controls workspace settings, access, deletion, and app publication.

Member
Creates content, adds lower-privilege users, and publishes the app.

Contributor
Creates and edits content; can update the app only when delegated.

Viewer
Views and interacts with content without authoring workspace items.

1. Add the instructor or designated owner as a second **Admin**.
2. Add report authors as **Contributors** unless they need to manage access or publish the app.
3. Add a test consumer as **Viewer**, or omit workspace access and grant that person access only through the app.
4. Record why each group needs its role. Remove temporary individual assignments after testing.

Need	Recommended access	Reason
Own settings and access	Admin	Only Admins can update/delete the workspace and fully manage roles.
Publish the app	Member	Members can publish, unpublish, and change app permissions.
Build reports and manage refresh	Contributor	Contributors can edit content and configure semantic model connections.
Consume governed content	App audience or Viewer	Avoids unnecessary authoring rights.

RLS reminder: workspace Admin, Member, and Contributor roles have edit permission and row-level security does not restrict them as ordinary consumers. Validate RLS with a Viewer or app-only consumer.

Collaborate without losing control

1. Publish the Coding-Forge report from Desktop to the new workspace, or move the instructor-approved copy if it is already in the service.
2. Confirm the workspace contains the report and its semantic model.
3. Agree on ownership: who edits the PBIX/PBIP source, who republishes, who approves access, and who responds to refresh failures.
4. Use comments and approved Microsoft 365 collaboration surfaces for review. Do not use workspace membership as a substitute for an approval process.
5. Test with the lowest role each person needs. A successful author test does not prove a consumer can open the report.

Do not use Publish to web. It creates unauthenticated public access and is not a collaboration mechanism for organizational or government content.

Create the published app

1. In the workspace, select **Create app**.
2. On **Setup**, enter a clear name, description, support contact, and approved theme color. Review advanced settings instead of accepting them blindly.
3. On **Content**, select **Add content**, include the Coding-Forge report, and arrange the navigation in the order consumers should follow.
4. Do not grant report-copy, semantic-model sharing, or Build permissions unless the audience has a documented need to create derivative content.
5. Select **Next: Add audience**.

One app per workspace: use audiences inside that app when groups need different views of the same governed content. If content has a different owner, lifecycle, or security boundary, use a separate workspace.

Design app audiences

**Coding-Forge
published app**

Leadership

Executive Review and Financial Health

Operations

Procurement Exposure and Financial Health

Analysts

All report pages; Build permission only when approved

1. Rename the default audience **Leadership** and make only the intended report content visible.
2. Select **New audience**, create **Operations**, and configure its visible content.
3. Add approved groups or test users to each audience. Avoid **Entire organization** for this exercise.
4. Expand audience advanced settings. Leave semantic-model sharing and Build permission off unless explicitly required.
5. Select **Publish app**, copy the app link, and test it with one user from each audience.
6. Return to the workspace, make a harmless description or navigation change, then select **Update app** to practice the staged release cycle.

Hidden is not always denied. If **Allow access to hidden content** is enabled, users with direct links can open hidden items. Use permissions, not navigation visibility alone, to enforce access.

Configure scheduled refresh

1. In the workspace, open the semantic model, then select **Refresh** → **Schedule refresh**.
2. Under **Gateway and cloud connections**, verify the source is mapped correctly. Cloud sources need valid credentials; on-premises sources require an available approved gateway and data-source definition.
3. Under **Data source credentials**, verify the authentication method. For this lab's public GitHub CSV sources, use the instructor-approved Anonymous configuration.
4. Turn **Configure a refresh schedule** on. Choose the correct time zone and schedule one off-hours daily refresh.
5. Keep owner failure notifications enabled and add a monitored internal contact or support alias where permitted.
6. Select **Apply**, run **Refresh now**, and inspect **Refresh history** until the result is **Completed** without unresolved warnings.

Capacity	Scheduled refresh limit	Operational note
Shared / Pro	Up to 8 per day	Manual UI refreshes do not consume the eight scheduled time slots.
PPU, Premium, or Fabric capacity	Up to 48 per day	Capacity resources and concurrency still constrain execution.

Monitor the schedule: Power BI can disable scheduled refresh after repeated failures and can pause it after two months of inactivity. A schedule is not an operating model until someone owns alerts and checks refresh history.

Validate as each persona

1. **Admin:** confirm access, contacts, app owner, and workspace settings.
2. **Contributor:** confirm authoring and refresh tasks work without access-management privileges.
3. **Leadership audience:** confirm only intended app content appears and the report is read-only.
4. **Operations audience:** confirm its navigation and content differ as designed.
5. Remove temporary test access and document the final owner, refresh cadence, support contact, and app link.

Microsoft Learn references

- [Create a workspace in Power BI](https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/collaborate-share/service-create-the-new-workspaces) (https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/collaborate-share/service-create-the-new-workspaces).
- [Roles in Power BI workspaces](https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/collaborate-share/service-roles-new-workspaces) (https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/collaborate-share/service-roles-new-workspaces).
- [Publish an app and manage audiences](https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/collaborate-share/service-create-distribute-apps) (https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/collaborate-share/service-create-distribute-apps).
- [Configure scheduled refresh](https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/connect-data/refresh-scheduled-refresh) (https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/connect-data/refresh-scheduled-refresh).
- [Data refresh concepts and operations](https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/connect-data/refresh-data) (https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-bi/connect-data/refresh-data).
- [Power BI for US Government customers](https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/fabric/enterprise/powerbi/service-government-us-overview) (https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/fabric/enterprise/powerbi/service-government-us-overview).

Microsoft updates the service interface regularly. If a label differs, use the linked Learn article and follow your tenant's current navigation and policies.

Completion check

0 of 8 complete

- ☐ Workspace created or approved workspace identified.
- ☐ Contacts and ownership recorded.
- ☐ Least-privilege roles assigned.
- ☐ Report and semantic model present.
- ☐ App content configured.
- ☐ Two audiences tested.
- ☐ Scheduled refresh configured.
- ☐ Refresh history and consumer access validated.